



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Liberty Common Schools
School Website: <https://libertycommon.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Liberty Common Schools (Fort Collins, CO) presents a robust, knowledge-centered, classical-leaning program across its K–12 system, with explicit emphasis on core knowledge, Great Books, liberal arts, and a strong parent partnership. Public-facing materials repeatedly foreground timeless aims—virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful—and describe a curriculum designed to build a contextual foundation of knowledge, cultivate character, and prepare students for thoughtful citizenship. The school openly rejects anti-intellectual trends and promotes a structured, traditional approach to education, including memory work, recitation, and Socratic-style discussion at the high-school level. Taken together, the six-category evaluation yields an overall CLASSICAL classification for Liberty Common Schools, with two areas showing only partial alignment (notably religious/metaphysical depth and explicit faculty portrait/formation language). The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- **Evidence:** Emphasis on virtue and the true/good/beautiful, plus a stated rejection of anti-intellectualism; occasional references to transcendent ideals in classical tradition, but little explicit theology or liturgical practice on public pages. See statements about virtue, truth, goodness, beauty, and anti-anti-intellectualism in Our Philosophy and Classical Education materials.
- **Positive keyword analysis:** truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; civic virtue. Estimated positives outpace negatives.
- **Why this rating:** The school foregrounds transcendent aims and virtuous formation but lacks explicit, stated theological or liturgical foundations in public pages. This yields a partial alignment with the Religious/Metaphysical Foundations criteria.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**
- **Evidence:** Formation-focused aims; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and a liberal-arts orientation; explicit grounding in the real, knowable true/good/beautiful; attention to formation over mere information; Great Books and classical ideals.
- **Positive keyword analysis:** formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, true/good/beautiful, telos, Great Conversation.
- **Why this rating:** The public materials consistently articulate formation toward virtue and human excellence, aligning closely with classical aims of education beyond job preparation.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**
- **Evidence:** Core Knowledge Sequence as foundational curriculum for K–8; strong emphasis on Great Books/Great-Books lists; liberal-arts integration; Latin; Mos Maiorum; Singapore Math; history as a throughline across disciplines; emphasis on a coherent, cumulative knowledge base.
- **Positive keyword analysis:** Core Knowledge Sequence, Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts, Latin, Mos Maiorum, history, coherence, knowledge base.

- Why this rating: The curriculum materials align with the classical emphasis on grammar/logic/rhetoric through explicit content—though Core Knowledge provides a knowledge-base approach rather than a purely ritual Great-Books core, it is paired with extensive classical content (Great Books, Latin, history across the curriculum). This yields strong CLASSICAL alignment.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials describe a classical pedagogy featuring memorization, recitation, narration, and Socratic-style discussion at the upper levels; explicit reference to classical education as a time-tested method with a focus on virtue and the liberal arts.
- Positive keyword analysis: Socratic, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, seminars, discussion, scholé/restful learning.
- Why this rating: The presence of Socratic-style engagement, memory-based pedagogy, and emphasis on rhetoric for upper grades demonstrates a strong classical pedagogy beyond rote, matching the Six Elements expectations. The explicit “Scholé” approach is reinforced by Classical-Education materials.
- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public pages foreground teacher leadership, the importance of teachers in delivering a knowledge-based program, and the notion of “the thinking framework” and moral formation, but explicit statements about the faculty as “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” or “faculty as a community of mentors” are less evident on the core site pages.
- Positive keyword analysis: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as mentors (where mentioned in classical-literature discourse, not consistently on Liberty pages). The site references the leadership of teachers and their role in the classroom but with less explicit language about a formal faculty-portrait or professional formation in classical pedagogy.
- Negative keyword analysis: limited explicit statements about a teacher-as-living-curriculum or a formal “portrait of a teacher”; absence of detailed faculty development language beyond general statements.
- Why this rating: The program shows clear teacher leadership and pedagogy consistent with classical aims, but the public-facing materials lack explicit, robust language about a formal “living curriculum” or teacher-portrait as a defined, codified element. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categorization.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Strong parent partnership ethos; explicit language that parents are co-teachers; volunteer expectations; open campus culture; parent formation through site content and suggested readings; information nights and family involvement.
- Positive keyword analysis: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental engagement, home-school alignment, parent formation, open campus, volunteering, family culture.
- Why this rating: The school clearly frames parents as integral to the educational project and actively engages families as co-educators, aligning with classical expectations for robust parent-community partnership.

Aggregate Assessment

- CLASSICAL: 4 categories (2, 3, 4, 6) align CLASSICAL; 2 categories (1, 5) align SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The preponderance of the six categories supports a CLASSICAL overall classification for Liberty Common Schools.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Increase explicit articulation of theology or liturgical/community practices within public-facing materials, while preserving the secular, classical core. This would strengthen alignment with the “Grounded in Theology” and “Liturgical and Communal Practices” criteria without compromising the school’s established orientation.

- For Element 5 (Faculty): Expand explicit public articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum, including a formal portrait of teacher roles, ongoing classical pedagogy professional development, and a clearly described teacher-formation path. This would move Element 5 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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